The Priests and the Glory

Exodus 28 · Exodus 33 · Exodus 40

The big idea: The high priest carried Israel's names on his heart. Moses would not go on without God's presence, and God promised it. Then the glory filled the tent. In Jesus the Word pitched his tent among us, and he always lives to intercede for us.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 28:29–38 | Exodus 33:12–17 | Exodus 40:34–38 | John 1:14

Open (5 minutes)

Who in your life has prayed for you faithfully? What difference did it make?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"So Aaron shall bear the names of the sons of Israel in the breastpiece of judgment on his _____, when he goes into the Holy Place." *(Exodus 28:29)*

"Then the cloud covered the tent of meeting, and the _____ of the LORD filled the tabernacle." *(Exodus 40:34)*

"Consequently, he is able to save to the _____ those who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to make intercession for them." *(Hebrews 7:25)*

Discuss

1. Moses prayed, "If your presence will not go with me, do not bring us up from here." What would you be tempted to settle for without God? *Exodus 33:14–16*

2. Christians together are now God's temple, and each believer's body is a temple of the Spirit. How should that change the way you treat your church, other believers, and your own body? *1 Corinthians 3:16; 6:19*

3. When Jesus died, the temple curtain was torn in two from top to bottom. What does that mean for how you come to God? *Matthew 27:51; Hebrews 10:19–20*

Memory verse

> *"And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory."*
>
> **John 1:14**

Pray

Thank Jesus that he carries your name before God and always lives to pray for you. Ask God to go with you into one hard thing this week.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 20

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Exodus 33:12–17 and 40:34–38 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Leviticus 1, 3, and 17:11).

Main points to land

1. Sinners needed a mediator. The high priest carried Israel's names on his heart and wore Holy to the LORD on his turban so the people would be accepted (Exodus 28:29, 36–38).
2. Moses would rather stay in the desert than go on without God. God promised, "My presence will go with you," and the glory filled the tent (Ex. 33:14–16; 40:34).
3. The glory filled the tent, and later the Word became flesh and pitched his tent among us. Jesus is the door, the sacrifice, the light, the bread, and the High Priest who tore the veil open, and by his Spirit his people are now God's temple (John 1:14; Hebrews 10:19–22).

Answer key (Observe)

1. heart
2. glory
3. uttermost

Questions people will ask

When Paul says "you are God's temple," does he mean my body?
In 1 Corinthians 3:16 the "you" is plural: the church together is God's temple, so dividing or harming the church is serious. In 1 Corinthians 6:19 Paul does speak of each believer's body as a temple of the Holy Spirit. Both are true, and the first is easy to miss.

Closing prayer

Lord Jesus, you are the Word who pitched his tent among us, and the High Priest who carries our names on your heart. Thank you that you always live to intercede for us. Go with us, and let your glory dwell among us. Amen.